DINESH R. PODDATURI, Ph.D.

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PROFILE

Applied economist working at the intersection of industrial organization, pricing, and experimentation, with over two years as economist and pricing advisor across 20+ client engagements, generating $27M in cumulative incremental revenue through demand estimation, controlled experimentation, and pricing optimization. Combines structural and reduced-form econometrics with hands-on client advisory experience translating economic analysis into decisions organizations act on.

EXPERIENCE

Economist Jul 2023 – Nov 2025; Oct 2026 – Present
Digonex (Dynamic Pricing Company) · Indianapolis, IN

- Generated $27M in cumulative incremental revenue (+34.6% over the engagement period) across 20+ client engagements in the U.S., U.K., and Canada through demand elasticity estimation, discrete choice analysis, and pricing optimization.
- Delivered $4.2M in pricing impact for a single client over three months by implementing dynamic pricing against real-time demand signals. Identified willingness-to-pay above the client's internal price ceiling, built the counterfactual case for lifting it, and earned expanded advisory scope as a result.
- Grew a client's annual revenue from $15.5M to $23M in 2025 by calibrating pricing dynamically to product value enhancements introduced during the year, updating pricing recommendations as new demand information became available.
- Built a centralized analytics pipeline integrating 100+ datasets across the entire client base, substantially reducing turnaround time on reporting and counterfactual analysis. Designed and executed A/B testing protocols to validate pricing recommendations causally before full deployment.
- Designed a segmented pricing experiment that produced an unexpected cross-segment revenue lift. Discounts targeted at one customer group drove higher purchase volume from a second group, producing net revenue growth that exceeded single-segment projections.

Doctoral Researcher, Department of Economics Aug 2018 – May 2023
Iowa State University · Ames, IA

- Developed dynamic structural economic models producing 10-year demand and pricing forecasts that outperformed USDA benchmark projections by 5%.
- Led three end-to-end research projects, from structural estimation and counterfactual simulation through peer-reviewed presentation at national economics conferences (WAEA 2022, AAEA 2021, AAEA 2020).
- Estimated short-run and long-run economic impacts of agricultural policy scenarios including disease outbreak response and national traceability program design, providing quantitative guidance for policymakers.

Additional Experience 2012 – 2018
Software Developer & Data Analyst, Iowa State University Extension and Outreach (2014–2018)
Systems Engineer, Infosys Limited (2012–2013)

- Built two market analysis tools in Java and SQL, used by producers across the U.S. and nine international countries.
- Led a team of six engineers developing an online banking software product and automated enterprise deployment into production, increasing team productivity by 10%.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, Iowa State University 2018 – 2023
Dissertation: Dynamic structural modeling, demand estimation, counterfactual simulation, policy impact analysis
M.S., Statistics, Iowa State University 2016 – 2018
M.S., Information Systems, Iowa State University 2014 – 2016
B.Tech., Electronics & Communication Engineering, CVR College of Engineering, India 2007 – 2011

SKILLS & RESEARCH

Methods Industrial organization, causal inference, demand estimation, discrete choice (BLP) models, merger simulation, counterfactual analysis, experimental design, A/B testing, DiD, synthetic controls, structural econometrics

Working Papers "Profit-Aware Pricing in Two-Sided Marketplaces" (2026). Available at SSRN.

"Estimating the Price Effects of the Blocked JetBlue-Spirit Merger" (2026). Available at dineshpoddaturi.github.io.

Open Source Switchback Experiment Framework for Marketplaces: Python simulation of a delivery-fee test in a three-sided marketplace, with power analysis and spillover diagnostics. Available on GitHub.

Programming Python, R, Stata, SQL, Java, LaTeX, Git, RStudio, Visual Studio